Tyco Fire Products

Frequently Asked Questions:

O-Ring Fire Sprinkler Head Notice

September 24, 2026

About the Notice

Q: What is this notice about?

The U.S. Consumer Product Safety Commission (CPSC), together with Tyco Fire Products LP, has issued public messaging alerting consumers, businesses, and property managers about a long-standing product issue involving certain Central Sprinkler, Gem Sprinkler and Star Sprinkler fire sprinkler heads that use an internal O-ring seal. These heads were sold and installed from approximately the 1970s until 2001, and they were the subject of a large-scale voluntary replacement program (VRP) that Central Sprinkler, in coordination with the CPSC, launched in 2001 and closed in 2007. The notice explains that some of these units may not have been replaced and may still be installed in homes, residential facilities, and commercial buildings. The CPSC and Tyco Fire Products are encouraging building owners to have their systems inspected and replace any recalled sprinklers. This notice is not about any other heads manufactured by Tyco or any other manufacturer.

Q: What is the "O-ring issue"?

The affected sprinkler heads use an internal O-ring radial seal design. Over time, minerals, salts, and other contaminants in water can degrade the rubber O-ring seals, which in some cases can cause the sprinkler head to fail to activate during a fire.

Q: How old are the sprinkler heads covered by this notice?

The affected sprinkler heads were manufactured decades ago, with some models dating as far back as the 1970s. They include Central, Gem, and Star models with O-ring seals manufactured through the late 1990s and, in some cases, into the early 2000s. Underwriters Laboratories (UL) later revised its sprinkler standards for manufacturers to prohibit O-ring water seal constructions altogether, with an effective manufacturing cutoff date of January 9, 2003. In other words, these are legacy components that have not been manufactured for well over twenty years.

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Q: Why doesn't every building show that its O-Ring sprinklers were replaced?

The VRP was a voluntary, nationwide program that depended on property owners identifying affected sprinkler heads and submitting them for replacement. Because responsibility for identifying, requesting, and completing sprinkler replacement work rested with individual property owners and their inspection and maintenance providers, some affected heads may not have been submitted for replacement during the program period, even where the manufacturer's recall notice, identification materials, and hotline remained available.

Q: Who is responsible for identifying and replacing affected O-Ring sprinkler heads today?

The National Fire Sprinkler Association (NFPA), which establishes rules for fire safety equipment, created NFPA 25 as the standard governing inspection, testing, and maintenance of water-based fire protection systems. Under NFPA 25, the property owner or its designated representative bears the ongoing responsibility for the inspection, testing, maintenance, and any necessary replacement of components in its fire sprinkler system. While NFPA 25 does not require the identification of recalled sprinkler heads as part of routine inspection, testing and maintenance, where a fire-protection inspector identifies a recalled component, NFPA 25 calls for that finding to be communicated to the owner in writing so that the owner can arrange for prompt replacement.

Q: Who can determine if I have heads that should be replaced?

This Notice specifically addresses a specific set of models with specific issues. Records of model numbers present at a facility and visual identification can determine if there are heads present at your property that need to be replaced. A licensed, qualified fire-protection inspector can identify any heads that were subject to the VRP and should be replaced. Information about the model numbers and visible characteristics of these heads are available at www.tyco-fire.com/Central-Sprinkler-O-Ring-Notice.

Q: What should I do if I believe my building may still have affected O-Ring sprinkler heads installed?

Building owners and designated representatives should review their sprinkler system records, consult with qualified, licensed fire-protection professionals, and inspect their systems to determine whether any installed sprinklers are of the type subject to the original VRP. If any affected sprinklers are identified, they should be replaced by a qualified fire-protection professional in accordance with applicable NFPA standards and any other applicable codes. Historical materials associated with the VRP, including model identification guidance, remain a helpful reference for confirming whether a given sprinkler head is part of the affected population.

Q: How can I verify whether a specific sprinkler head is one of the affected models?

Model identification information for the affected sprinkler heads, including manufacturer markings, model numbers, and other identifying features, is available at www.tyco-fire.com/Central-Sprinkler-O-Ring-Notice. Building owners and their fire-protection contractors can use this information to compare against the markings on installed sprinkler heads and confirm whether a given unit falls within the affected population.

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Please note that Tyco Fire Products began transitioning from O-ring seals to Belleville seals in 1998. Because some sprinkler model designations remained unchanged after the transition, recalled sprinkler models with date codes from 1998 or later should be inspected to verify the seal type installed. The model identification guide, available at www.tyco-fire.com/Central-Sprinkler-O-Ring-Notice, provides instructions for distinguishing between O-ring and Belleville seal configurations. Belleville seal technology remains the industry standard for fire sprinkler applications.

Q: What are proper replacement heads for the sprinkler heads that were subject to the VRP?

A list of approved replacement models and specifications is available at www.tyco-fire.com/Central-Sprinkler-O-Ring-Notice. Ensure that any replacement head is appropriate for the specific system configuration, including coverage area, temperature rating, orientation, and response characteristics. All replacements should be performed in accordance with applicable NFPA standards and any other applicable codes.

Additional Resources

Q: Where can I get more information or verify whether my sprinklers are affected?

Additional information about the affected O-Ring sprinklers, including identification guidance, is available through CPSC.gov, and consumers can report safety concerns at www.SaferProducts.gov or by calling the CPSC's hotline at 800-638-2772. Property owners are encouraged to consult a qualified, licensed fire-protection professional to inspect their systems and confirm compliance with applicable NFPA standards.

Q: To whom can I escalate concerns within Tyco Fire Products?

Tyco Fire Products has established a website with additional information at www.tyco-fire.com/Central-Sprinkler-O-Ring-Notice, and we ask that you check there first. Additional questions may be submitted to Tyco Fire Products at: Central-Sprinkler-O-Ring-Notice@jci.com.

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